

Eyes and seeing

Sight is the most important sense because it provides you with pictures of the world and what is happening around you. You don't see only with your eyes but also with your brain. Your eyes detect light and send signals to your brain, which puts them together to create the moving, color, 3-D images that you see.

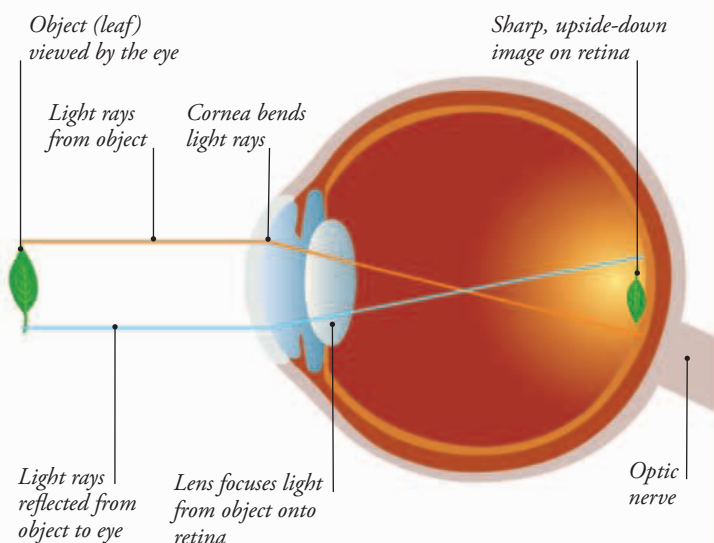
HOW YOUR EYES WORK

Light bouncing off objects enters your eyes through a transparent window at the front, called the cornea. It then passes through an opening, the pupil, and the flexible lens, which focuses the light on the retina at the back of your eye. From here, signals are sent to your brain along the optic nerve.

Just one-sixth of the eyeball can be seen from the outside.

IMAGE MAKING

When light rays from an object hit your eye, they are bent by the cornea and lens. The rays cross inside your eye to make a clear but upside-down image on the retina. This information is sent along the optic nerve to your brain, which flips the image right side up.



Muscles adjust the lens shape so it can focus light from any distance.

The iris controls how much light enters the eye.

The pupil is the opening that allows light into the inside of the eye.

The cornea is a clear layer that helps focus light.

The lens changes shape to fine-focus light on the retina.

The white of the eye, or sclera, is the tough outer layer of the eyeball.

Muscles on the outside of the eye move the eyeball in its socket.